

Aaron Gogna

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Summary

Digital strategy and transformation leader with 14 years of management consulting experience helping the world's most recognizable brands define their strategic direction and turn it into measurable growth.

My experience spans financial services, fintech, B2B and B2C technology, with engagements covering growth strategy, digital and AI transformation, product and platform strategy, customer experience optimization, monetization and operating model design. My work sits at the intersection of art and science, pairing analytical rigor with design, people and process leadership to build systems and experiences that are grounded in logic, drive change, and scale effectively.

Relevant Experience

Director, Strategy @ Apply Digital

2024 to Present | Toronto, ON, Canada

Lead consulting engagements for the world's most recognized brands, including the NBA, Kraft Heinz, Lululemon, and SC Johnson, covering omnichannel digital strategy, CX transformation, DXP platform and AI strategy and implementation, product ideation, design, builds, launches and management, business casing (ROI quantification), operating model transformation and change management.

Apply Digital is one of Canada's fastest-growing digital and AI consultancies, recognized by Forrester alongside Accenture, Deloitte, and McKinsey as a leader in digital transformation.

- Delivered large-scale, simultaneous digital transformation programs in complex, high-ambiguity environments across industries, framing and structuring ambiguous problems and taking initiatives from ideation and hypothesis development through validation, concepting, design, build, pilot deployment, scaling, and handoff to long-term business owners.
- Advised on projects across the full range of work that enterprises need to transform and grow, including business strategy, digital/omnichannel strategy, content/UX optimization, AI discovery and builds, brand strategy, product conceptualization and roll-out, tech/DXP platform strategy and implementation, sales readiness and operating model design.
- Led pitches for enterprise business and technology transformation engagements ranging from \$500K to \$5M+, shaping the strategic narrative, owning the room in client-facing proposals, and converting opportunities into long-term retained relationships through continuous account growth.
- Owned core program artifacts for complex, multi-workstream transformation programs, including program charters, project plans, KPI dashboards, business cases, and executive readouts, while establishing operating models, escalation paths, governance cadences, and decision forums that kept programs moving.
- Built rapid command of unfamiliar business contexts at Fortune 500s and disruptors, getting to trusted advisor status with senior leaders within weeks of engagement kickoff across unfamiliar industries, business models, and technical domains.
- Acted as the primary driver, integrator, and facilitator across multi-workstream initiatives, aligning senior leaders from Product, Engineering, Data, Design, Marketing, Sales, and Operations around critical issues, decisions, dependencies and execution plans.

- Identified, mapped, and drove the people, process, and technology changes required to operationalize solutions, including capability shifts, workflow redesign, system and platform integration, and tooling adoption, partnering with Change and Communications teams to embed new ways of working.
- Set the standard for how complex digital transformation engagements and sprints were run, designing and implementing repeatable frameworks, templates, governance mechanisms, and operating models that translated business, customer, partner, and technical insights into priorities and clear direction.
- Shaped enterprise digital/AI strategy and implementation across consumer and internal use cases, including Kraft Heinz's TasteMaker platform, uncovering the opportunity, framing the business case, aligning cross-functional teams, and supporting rollout to 1,200+ users across Marketing, Design, R&D, and Innovation, compressing concept-to-market timelines from 8 weeks to 8 days and unlocking \$37M in YTD 2025 value.
- Identified new revenue generation and competitive parity opportunities, building and scaling a net-new pricing and monetization practice within Apply Digital, developing proprietary methodologies, analytical frameworks, templates, and tooling, then embedding them into live client engagements to generate \$1M+ in revenue impact within the first 6 months.
- Hired and coached high-performing teams, developing junior strategists and product leads into engagement owners with stronger problem framing, analytical rigor, facilitation, structured communication, cross-functional leadership, and executive presence.

Director and Head of Customer Experience, North America @ Simon-Kucher
2015 to 2024 | New York, NY, USA

Promoted 8 times over 10 years, founded and scaled North America's Customer Experience practice, and led revenue growth engagements for the world's most recognized brands, including Mastercard, RBC, Shutterstock, and Cloudflare, spanning end-to-end customer experience transformation, pricing and packaging, revenue model overhaul, product strategy and management, go-to-market strategy, and sales effectiveness.

Simon-Kucher is a 2,000-person global consultancy founded in Germany in 1985 and widely regarded as the world's leading firm on pricing, monetization, and revenue growth strategy.

- Led strategy and transformation programs across B2B and B2C technology, financial services, and retail clients, spanning strategic planning, pricing and packaging, revenue model redesign, sales strategy, product innovation, customer experience transformation, UX optimization, website/content strategy, and operating model redesign, then translated recommendations into cross-functional execution plans and governance structures.
- Founded North America's Customer Experience practice, hiring and coaching a 10-person team, establishing repeatable methodologies and templates, facilitation approaches, Lean Six-Sigma-informed process improvement frameworks, and delivery standards needed to deliver complex transformation programs across journey mapping and customer experience redesign, e-commerce strategy, customer lifecycle engagement, and product ideation/launches.
- Built, owned and challenged financial and operational models, including revenue forecasting, margin analyses, resource planning and workflow impacts, ensuring analytical rigor, root cause clarity, and sound judgment while helping senior leaders evaluate tradeoffs, risks, and downstream impacts.
- Directed large-scale primary research programs and diagnostic workstreams, using evidence from internal teams, operators, customers, and market data to uncover what was really happening inside complex business problems, separate symptoms from root causes, validate or disprove hypotheses, and identify the barriers preventing growth, adoption, and execution.

- Facilitated high-stakes executive decision-making forums and led cross-functional alignment across Product, Sales, Marketing, Finance, Operations, Risk, Legal, and Technology, helping establish priorities, resolve dependencies, and move strategic decisions into execution across complex matrix organizations.
- Built executive-level presentations for CTOs, COOs, CPOs, CMOs, CFOs and board members, translating findings, business cases, technical implications and roadmaps into clear narratives that influenced multi-year growth and investment decisions.
- Applied behavioral economics to transformation programs where success depended on changing how customers, sales teams, or internal stakeholders made decisions. For example, helped a major financial institution redesign its digital onboarding journey, making tradeoffs clearer for customers by leveraging the Zeigarnik effect and improving multi-product adoption by 200%+ in pilot cohorts.
- Owned and grew high-value client relationships across multi-year engagements, leading proposal development, pitching new scopes of work, expanding accounts through continuous selling, and converting first-phase wins into long-term retained partnerships.

Embedded Strategy, Product and CX Advisor @ Qapital
2016 to 2022 | New York, NY, USA

As Simon-Kucher's lead consultant on the account, I embedded with the co-CEOs over six years as a trusted advisor, helping scale the platform from a single product, pre-revenue startup to a monetized, multi-product platform with 2M+ users and \$2.8B in deposits. Owned product strategy across the full portfolio, subscription model design, go-to-market strategy and launches, UX and customer experience optimization, and intelligence (voice-of-customer and market).

Qapital is a B2C fintech known for applying behavioral economics to automate finance habits across saving, budgeting, investing, and debt management.

- Embedded as the strategic growth partner to Qapital's co-CEOs and GTM, CX, Product, and Design teams over 6 years, aligning senior leaders around priorities, tradeoffs, and execution plans while driving its growth from early-stage fintech to a 2M+ user, \$2.8B-deposit business and Google Play's "Most Innovative App" and Apple's "Best App for Savings."
- Architected Qapital's subscription model, designing pricing, packaging, value propositions, and features to drive 82%+ contribution margins and a path to projected \$238M in subscription revenue by 2025.
- Drove Qapital's evolution from a single-product savings app to a multi-product fintech platform, leading 0 to 1 launches across the entire portfolio, including Spending (checking + debit), Invest, Payday Divvy, Spending Sweet Spot, and Money Missions, unlocking 6x ARPU expansion.
- Designed and optimized Qapital's onboarding, engagement, and retention experiences in partnership with Product and CX teams, turning customer behavior and adoption barriers into prioritized improvements that drove 4M+ goals created, 400+ monthly touchpoints per power user, and 98%+ monthly retention – metrics more typical of social apps than finance apps.
- Advised Qapital on customer acquisition strategy across paid, organic, and referral channels, helping scale the user base to 2M+ while supporting funnel diagnostics, performance tracking, and targeted interventions that delivered category-leading subscriber unit economics: 12.6x LTV/CAC, 10-month payback, and 84%+ gross margins on a \$110 ARPU base.
- Achieved measurable customer experience outcomes, including a 93rd-percentile NPS (57 vs. 32 industry average) and 4.8-star App Store rating across 80,000+ reviews, with feature coverage in The Atlantic, Forbes, NYT, and Good Morning America.

Research Lead, Consumer Psychology and Decision Science @ University of Toronto
2012 to 2015 | Toronto, ON, Canada

Worked in the university's behavioral economics research lab under PhD faculty, designing and running field and laboratory experiments on consumer decision-making and choice architecture, then analyzing results and contributing to published research outputs.

- Led behavioral economics research on the hidden drivers of human judgment and decision-making, studying how incentives, risk, cognitive bias, choice architecture, and uncertainty shape what people perceive, prioritize, avoid, trust, and ultimately choose.
- Turned ambiguous research questions into structured analyses, using quantitative models and behavioral data to identify root causes, decision drivers, patterns, and implications, then communicated findings through written analyses, presentations, and visual outputs for senior academic stakeholders.

Select Client Experience

Experience advising market leaders, regulated enterprises, digital-first platforms, complex multi-brand organizations and disruptors across growth strategy, digital and AI transformation, customer experience, technology implementation, operating model design, and monetization.

Notable clients include, but aren't limited to:

- **Financial Services, Fintech & Payments:** Mastercard, Capital One, Chase, RBC, TD, CIBC, BMO, Scotiabank, Allstate, Finastra (D+H), PayNet, Qapital, Cadre, IPC, Carson Group Partners, etc.
- **Technology, Digital Platforms & Infrastructure:** Cloudflare, HubSpot, ADP, NRG, FreshBooks, PowerDMS, Unionware, Chipworks, Prodigy, Quicken, ListenFirst, etc.
- **Consumer, Retail & Industrial:** Kraft Heinz, Canadian Tire, John Deere, SC Johnson, Shutterfly, Lululemon, Arc'teryx, Azek, JELD-WEN, Marker Trax, etc.
- **Sports, Health, Wellness & Public-Interest:** NBA, NFL, Moderna, AAMC, NASM, Hydrafacial, Curology, Zumba, RealSelf, etc.